WHY THE MOON CHANGES SHAPE

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the passage carefully. Answer the questions; for the multiple choice, circle one answer. Look back at the text before you decide, and use full sentences for the written answer.

Why the Moon Changes Shape

143 words

Some nights the moon is a thin sliver. Some nights it is a full, bright circle. The moon itself is not changing. It is always a round ball of rock. What changes is how much of its sunlit side we can see. The moon does not make its own light. It shines because sunlight bounces off it, like light off a mirror. As the moon travels around Earth, which takes about a month, the sun lights it from different angles. When the moon is between Earth and the sun, we face its dark side, and the moon seems to disappear. That is a new moon. As it moves on, a sliver appears and grows a little each night. Halfway through the month we see the whole lit side: a full moon. Then the lit part shrinks again. These changing shapes are called phases.

1. What is the moon made of?

light | rock | ice

2. Where does the moon's light come from?

the sun | a fire inside the moon | Earth

3. If you see a full moon tonight, about how long until the next full moon? THINK

one night | one week | about one month

4. In this text, "phases" means WORD

planets | the moon's changing shapes | clouds

5. Explain in your own words why we cannot see the moon at new moon.

WHY THE MOON CHANGES SHAPE

ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the passage carefully. Answer the questions; for the multiple choice, circle one answer. Look back at the text before you decide, and use full sentences for the written answer.

Why the Moon Changes Shape

143 words

Some nights the moon is a thin sliver. Some nights it is a full, bright circle. The moon itself is not changing. It is always a round ball of rock. What changes is how much of its sunlit side we can see. The moon does not make its own light. It shines because sunlight bounces off it, like light off a mirror. As the moon travels around Earth, which takes about a month, the sun lights it from different angles. When the moon is between Earth and the sun, we face its dark side, and the moon seems to disappear. That is a new moon. As it moves on, a sliver appears and grows a little each night. Halfway through the month we see the whole lit side: a full moon. Then the lit part shrinks again. These changing shapes are called phases.

1. What is the moon made of?

light | **rock** | ice

2. Where does the moon's light come from?

the sun | a fire inside the moon | Earth

3. If you see a full moon tonight, about how long until the next full moon? THINK

one night | one week | **about one month**

4. In this text, "phases" means WORD

planets | **the moon's changing shapes** | clouds

5. Explain in your own words why we cannot see the moon at new moon.

The moon is between Earth and the sun, so the side facing us is dark; the sunlit side faces away from us.